

OPUDA'S PAINT · VOLUME TWO

Room Book

Four methods for choosing colour by the job it has to do

2026 · PORT HARCOURT

A colour is not a scheme

A colour on a chip is a decision about paint. A scheme is a decision about a room: which surface carries the colour, which surface stays quiet, and where the light lands. The same pot of Atlantic Blue is a calm bedroom wall or an overwhelming one depending entirely on the two metres next to it.

So this book is organised by job rather than by colour. A method is a problem that shows up in almost every job we quote — the surface you cannot afford to paint twice, the cheap face, the room that is too dark, the detail that decides the whole elevation — and each one is shown on a wall we have actually painted.

> *Choose the surfaces, not the colours. The colours are the easy part.*

TWO VOLUMES

Colour Book
the library, indexed by colour — nine families, 59 colours, 9 palettes

Room Book
the library, indexed by the job the colour has to do

Set in Instrument Serif and Archivo. Plates are OPUDA'S site photographs with a wall repainted; every colour, code and LRV comes from the data that serves opudapaint.com.

Contents

Four methods, then the collections they draw from, then the order to decide in. Each method is a problem that turns up on almost every job we quote.

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Sixteen colourways on four real Port Harcourt sites.

How to read this book

Each method opens with the problem and what it costs to get wrong, then shows colourways on one of our own jobs. Every plate carries the same three things.

THE PLATE

A real photograph from an OPUDA'S site, with a wall repainted in the colour listed beneath it. Nothing else in the picture has been altered — not the furniture, not the sky, not the unfinished floor.

THE COLOURWAY

Three or four colours with a role each. A scheme is not a set of colours; it is an order, and the role line tells you which surface each one is for.

THE LRV

Light reflectance value, 0–100, estimated from the digital value. It is how much of the light in the room the surface gives back. Choose the darkest plane in the room last, and check its number before you commit.

WHAT A RENDERED PLATE IS NOT

A repainted photograph is a simulation of a paint film on a wall, and the simulation has limits: it cannot model the sheen of a finish at a grazing angle, the way an emulsion covers a patch, or the colour of the light at eight in the evening. It is a better decision aid than a chip and a worse record than a sample pot. Paint a 500 mm square on the actual wall, look at it at night, and then order.

The colour behind the light

Two wall colours, one room, and the difference each one makes

Almost every room we are asked to look at has one wall the light actually comes from. Paint it the same as the others and the room goes flat; paint it the darkest colour you like and the room turns into a tunnel. The wall around the opening is the one surface whose colour you will see most often and judge most quickly — from the doorway, from the corridor, in the two seconds before anyone walks in.

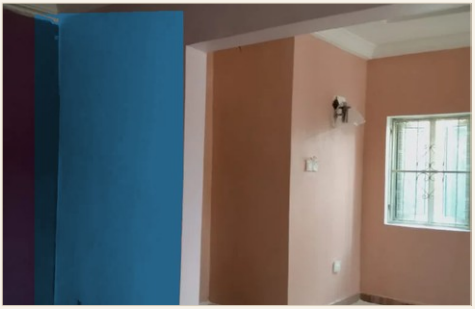
01

THE PRINCIPLE

Give the opening wall the second-deepest colour in the scheme, never the deepest. The deepest belongs on the feature plane the light does not touch.

Colourways

THE BEDROOM AT RUMUOKORO

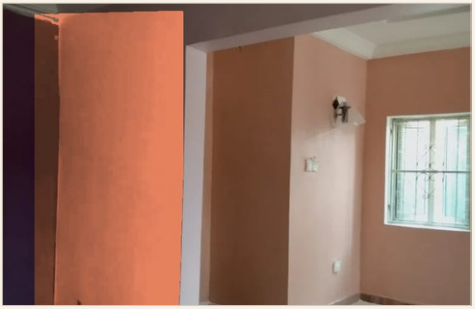


Evening Room

Atlantic Blue
OP-301 · LRV 7 · Wall beside the opening

PAIR WITH OP-004

Atlantic on the wall beside the opening; the reveal stays pale

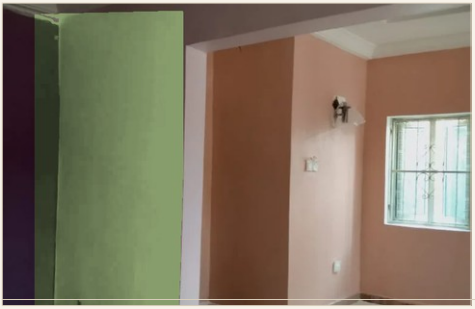


Clay Room

Terracotta
OP-401 · LRV 20 · Wall beside the opening

PAIR WITH OP-008

Terracotta warms the corridor before anyone walks in



Moss Room

Moss Room
OP-217 · LRV 18 · Wall beside the opening

PAIR WITH OP-010

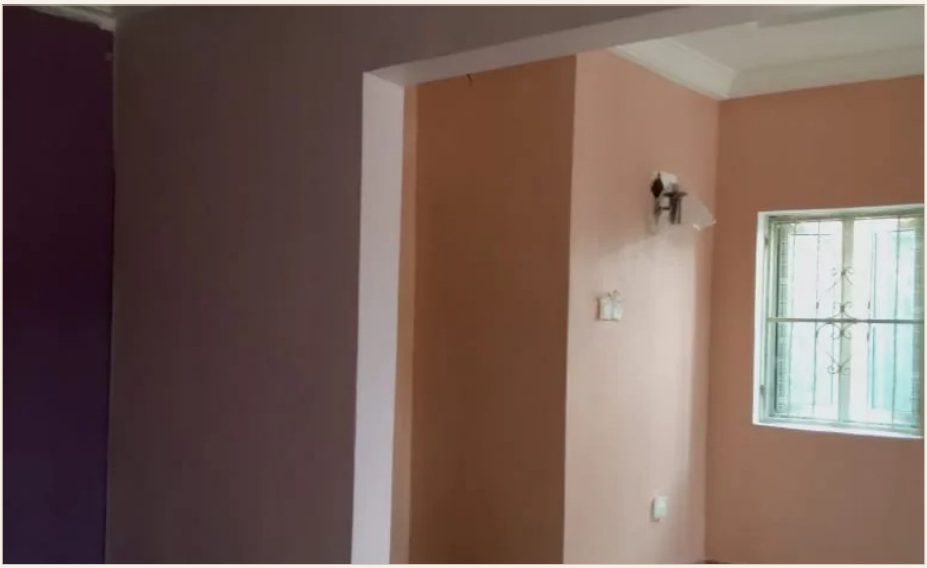
A green that reads as a neutral from the doorway

Give the opening wall the second-deepest colour in the scheme, never the deepest. The deepest belongs on the feature plane the light does not touch.

The plate

The bedroom at Rumuokoro

1 repaintable plane · three planes, one light source



The photograph as taken. Every plate in this chapter starts from this frame.

REPAINTED

main wall

LEFT ALONE

Floors, ceilings, joinery, furniture, sky and every other surface in the frame

HOW

The wall's own luminance normalised against its mean, then multiplied by the chosen paint — so shadows, corners and highlights survive

SHARED

16.1% of the frame is repainted; nothing else is touched

When the surface is the problem

Skim, prime, or paint — decided before the colour is chosen

Plaster varies. A wall that has been skimmed twice takes colour differently from a wall built of block and rendered in one pass, and a wall that has been patched takes it differently again — the patches pull at the paint and show through a pale colour as a ghost you cannot unsee. No amount of quality in the topcoat fixes a substrate that was not sealed.

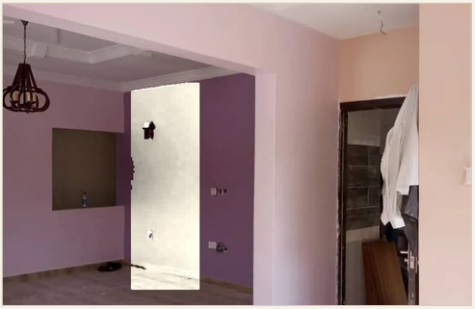
02

THE PRINCIPLE

Decide the system before the colour: one coat of alkali-resisting primer over the whole wall, not just the repairs. A tinted primer also removes the third coat that a deep colour would otherwise need.

Colourways

THE FEATURE WALL AT GRA PHASE 2

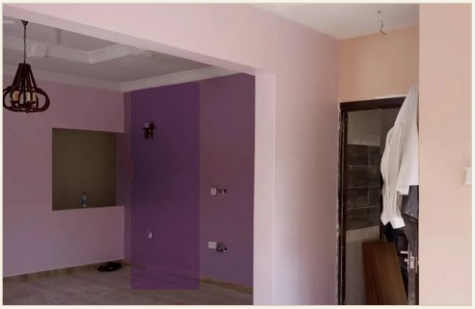


Sealed and Pale

Bone
OP-010 · LRV 74 · Feature wall

PAIR WITH OP-008

Bone over one full priming coat; no patch shows through

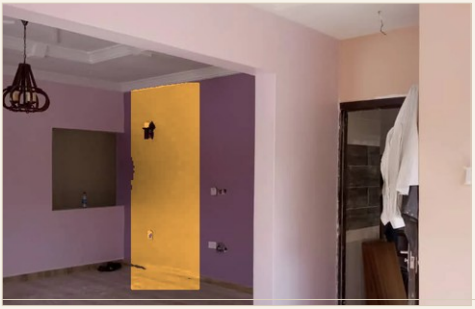


Sealed and Deep

Aubergine
OP-601 · LRV 4 · Feature wall

PAIR WITH OP-004

Aubergine after a tinted primer, so two coats finish it



Sealed and Warm

Ochre
OP-505 · LRV 30 · Feature wall

PAIR WITH OP-020

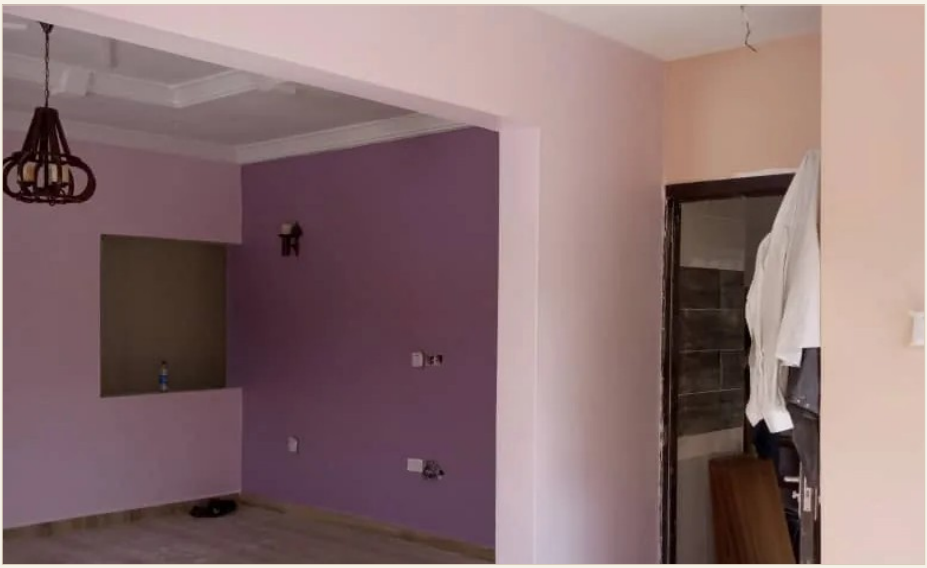
Ochre on a wall that was skimmed in two passes

Decide the system before the colour: one coat of alkali-resisting primer over the whole wall, not just the repairs. A tinted primer also removes the third coat that a deep colour would otherwise need.

The plate

The feature wall at GRA Phase 2

1 repaintable plane · one wall changed, everything else left alone



The photograph as taken. Every plate in this chapter starts from this frame.

REPAINTED

feature wall

LEFT ALONE

Floors, ceilings, joinery, furniture, sky and every other surface in the frame

HOW

The wall's own luminance normalised against its mean, then multiplied by the chosen paint — so shadows, corners and highlights survive

SHARED

4.7% of the frame is repainted; nothing else is touched

The surface a street judges first

Boundary walls, plinths and the band that separates them

A boundary wall is the largest painted surface most of our customers own and the one nobody thinks about until it is wrong. It has to work in flat light and in sun, from twenty metres and from the pavement, next to brick or stone that will not be repainted. Get the band wrong and the whole elevation looks like an afterthought; get it right and it reads as architecture.

03

THE PRINCIPLE

Two surfaces, two values. Keep the panel pale enough to throw the brick forward, and take the plinth band a full step darker than the panel so the wall stops looking like it is floating.

Colourways

THE BOUNDARY WALL AT GRA PHASE 2



Pale Ground

Opuda White
OP-001 · LRV 91 · Wall panels

Terracotta
OP-401 · LRV 20 · Plinth band

White panel, brick plinth, nothing else



Harmattan Band

Savannah Sand
OP-104 · LRV 59 · Wall panels

Brick Lane
OP-409 · LRV 10 · Plinth band

Sand panel with a deeper clay line



Delta Shadow

Bonny Haze
OP-136 · LRV 53 · Wall panels

Rust Ember
OP-425 · LRV 10 · Plinth band

A pale grey panel against red brick

Two surfaces, two values. Keep the panel pale enough to throw the brick forward, and take the plinth band a full step darker than the panel so the wall stops looking like it is floating.

The plate

The boundary wall at GRA Phase 2

2 repaintable planes · the surface a street actually judges you by



The photograph as taken. Every plate in this chapter starts from this frame.

REPAINTED

wall panels, brick base

LEFT ALONE

Floors, ceilings, joinery, furniture, sky and every other surface in the frame

HOW

The wall's own luminance normalised against its mean, then multiplied by the chosen paint — so shadows, corners and highlights survive

SHARED

13.0%, 2.7% of the frame is repainted; nothing else is touched

Contrast is chosen, not discovered

Ironwork, frames and the dark line that holds a facade together

The darkest surface on a building is usually a decision made by default — the gate is black because gates are black. But the dark line is what the eye reads as structure: it is the difference between a fence that belongs to a wall and a fence that was installed next to one. On ironwork it also decides how loudly the metalwork announces itself from the road.

04

THE PRINCIPLE

One dark accent, used consistently, and never two darks at different temperatures. If the gate is charcoal, the railings are charcoal; a warm brown gate beside a cold grey railing looks like a mistake because it is one.

Colourways

THE GATE ON A RUMUOLA BOUNDARY



Charcoal Line

Window Black
OP-717 · LRV 1 · Ironwork

PAIR WITH OP-321

One black, everywhere, including the railings



Atlantic Iron

Indigo Night
OP-321 · LRV 3 · Ironwork

PAIR WITH OP-701

A cool blue-black reads softer from the road



Deep Green

Opuda Green
OP-201 · LRV 11 · Ironwork

PAIR WITH OP-713

A green-dark that ties the gate to a garden

One dark accent, used consistently, and never two darks at different temperatures. If the gate is charcoal, the railings are charcoal; a warm brown gate beside a cold grey railing looks like a mistake because it is one.

The plate

The gate on a Rumuola boundary

1 repaintable plane · ironwork is a colour decision too



The photograph as taken. Every plate in this chapter starts from this frame.

REPAINTED

ironwork

LEFT ALONE

Floors, ceilings, joinery, furniture, sky and every other surface in the frame

HOW

The wall's own luminance normalised against its mean, then multiplied by the chosen paint — so shadows, corners and highlights survive

SHARED

27.4% of the frame is repainted; nothing else is touched

Four collections, four arguments

The library is grouped into collections. They are not seasons and they are not trend forecasts: each one is a position on how colour should behave in Nigerian light, and each is a starting point rather than a rule.

The Signature

28 COLOURS

OP-001 Opuda White | OP-004 Coconut Milk | OP-020 Stone White | OP-008 Limestone

The house range. Neutrals and deeps that will not date, specified on more of our jobs than everything else combined — which is also why they are the ones we can speak about with the most confidence.

The Delta Edit

07 COLOURS

OP-012 Ivory Coast | OP-605 Lilac Room | OP-136 Bonny Haze | OP-613 Mauve Linen

Colours taken from finished jobs around Port Harcourt: a lilac lounge in GRA, a turquoise boundary wall in Rumuola. Every one of them has been mixed for a real customer and seen on a real wall.

Harmattan

17 COLOURS

OP-313 Powder Blue | OP-621 Blush Room | OP-104 Savannah Sand | OP-517 Apricot Wall

Dust-warm. December light is flatter and cooler than the rest of the year, and these are the colours that hold their temperature in it — sand, clay, ochre, and the reds that read warm without going hot.

Rain Season

07 COLOURS

OP-229 Eucalyptus Mist | OP-225 Sage Whisper | OP-221 Olive Branch | OP-217 Moss Room

Greens and cool neutrals for the months when the light never gets above grey. In a rainy-season room a green is effectively a neutral; these are the ones that stay green instead of going grey.

Which surface takes which method

The four methods are not rooms; they are surfaces. A job usually needs two or three of them at once, and the order below is the order they should be decided in.

APERTURE

Doorway walls, reveals, corridor ends, any wall with an opening in it

SUBSTRATE

Skimmed plaster, patched walls, block and render, ceilings

THRESHOLD

Boundary walls, plinths, gatehouses, retaining walls

DEPTH

Ironwork, frames, doors, shutters, the plinth of a facade

ON A TYPICAL HOUSE

Threshold on the boundary wall and plinth; Aperture on the entrance and the walls either side of the openings; Depth on the gate, railings and shutters; Substrate on everything that has been rendered in one pass.

WHY THIS ORDER

Because a substrate decision can force a colour decision, and a colour decision can never force a substrate one. If the wall needs a tinted primer, the topcoat changes; if the topcoat changes, the primer does not.

The order to decide in

01

Surface, then colour

Decide what is being painted and how it will be sealed before choosing anything. A colour chosen before the substrate is a colour chosen twice.

02

One plane at a time

Write the scheme down as surfaces with roles — feature, main, ceiling, trim — not as a list of colours. A scheme with no roles is a palette, and a palette is not a plan.

03

Check the darkest number

The deepest colour in the scheme sets how much light the room gives back. If its LRV is under 20, plan the lighting before you plan the paint.

04

Sample on the wall

Two coats on a 500 mm square, right to the edge, and live with it for a day. Every plate in this book is a simulation; the wall is not.

The paint is the last decision. The surfaces are the first, and they are the ones that cannot be changed without sanding.

TRADE COUNTER

Port Harcourt · Rivers State

Colour mixing and trade sales · 0902 642 4350

Dealers nationwide · opudapaint.com/dealers

hello@opudapaint.com

OPUDA'S PAINT

Masters of the surface.

Volume two of the colour library: four methods for choosing paint by the job it has to do, shown on rooms we have actually painted.

THE SERIES

Colour Book
the library, indexed by colour

Room Book
the library, indexed by the job

opudapaint.com
Colour library, calculator, dealers

hello@opudapaint.com
Enquiries and specification support

Port Harcourt
Rivers State, Nigeria

Plates are OPUDA'S site photographs with a wall repainted. A repainted photograph is a simulation: confirm every choice against a physical chip before ordering.